

Teo Mendoza

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[Portfolio](#) | [GitHub](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

Education

Willamette University
B.S. in Computer Science

Expected Graduation: Fall 2026
GPA: 3.95

Work Experience

Contract Backend Developer - KHV Games

May 2026 - August 2026

- Sole backend developer on a 3-person team building an online RPG in Rust on SpacetimeDB; owned the server architecture and the systems teammates built content on.
- Built a component-based enemy AI framework where attack and movement patterns compose into arbitrary behaviors, letting teammates create new enemies with no new code.
- Designed a data-driven item and inventory pipeline using enum-based dynamic dispatch, so new items ship as data only.
- Implemented server-authoritative client-server synchronization and the login and connection system that persists player data.

Pedagogical - Project Manager & Lead Developer

May 2025 - August 2025

- Led a 3-person team building an NSF-funded learning platform (ASP.NET, EF Core, PostgreSQL), later deployed to 150 students in a Spring 2026 university study; ran Agile sprints and served as liaison to the faculty lead.
- Wrote 80% of the code across the backend, database and client, and oversaw system design, including redesigns for classroom-scale deployment.
- Designed an LLM feedback pipeline that maintains rolling student profiles in place of full student-history prompts, keeping feedback consistent over long interactions and cutting tokens per call by an estimated 25%.
- Oversaw a CI/CD pipeline with unit tests that gates production releases on a passing build.

Resident Advisor - Willamette University

August 2024 - May 2025

- Supervised 50 residents within a 600+ student housing community; mediated conflicts and responded to crises.

Projects

Birthright - Online 1v1 Card Game

- Built the game on a Godot client and a Rust SpacetimeDB module that handles authoritative game state and turn resolution.
- Enforced server-side, per-connection view filtering so clients never receive hidden state such as the opponent's hand or enemy data.
- Implemented matchmaking and reconnect/desync recovery; built all game content as fully data-driven, so new content needs zero code changes.
- Shipped publicly on itch.io to 50 players and selected to present at the Portland Retro Gaming Expo (30k estimated attendees).

Skills

Languages: Rust, C#, Python, SQL, TypeScript, Bash

Backend: ASP.NET, EF Core, PostgreSQL, SpacetimeDB, Docker, Server-Authoritative Architecture, Data-Driven Development

Tools: Git/GitHub, CI/CD, Claude Code (agentic development)

Publications

Mendoza, T., et al. (2025). *Not All Chatbots Teach: Evidence for Pedagogical Design in AI-Assisted Technical Education*. ACM SIGCITE 2025.